

Cohort A – APR Initiative Alignment

Program/Degree	Assessment Year	Program Learning Outcomes/Student Learning Outcomes	Assessment Finding/Concern	Analysis of Assessment Results	Improvement Action Taken	Results of Improvement Action
Business AAS	2023-2024	PLO 5- Interpret accounting information, marketing practices, and economic data and be creative with business solutions.	Assessment results showed that student performance on PLO 5 consistently fell below the expected benchmark over the three-year review period. The results indicated a recurring weakness in students' ability to apply accounting concepts and skills.	Faculty analysis of the three-year PLO 5 results identified applied accounting skills as an area requiring continued reinforcement. Faculty determined that providing students with additional, flexible tutoring support in ACCT 1010 and ACCT 1020 could strengthen their ability to interpret accounting information, apply accounting concepts, and solve business-related problems.	Implemented additional tutoring support through Tutor.com for students enrolled in ACCT 1010 and ACCT 1020 to provide accessible assistance with accounting concepts and applied problem-solving skills.	In Progress. Tutor.com support has been made available to students in accounting courses. Subsequent PLO 5 assessment results will be analyzed to determine whether the additional tutoring support contributes to improved student achievement and progress toward the established benchmark.
Administrative Professional Technology TC	2023-2024	PLO 3- Students will prepare documents pertinent to an office environment. PLO 1- Students will demonstrate skill development in software applications common to most modern business offices.	Because the program was new, sufficient PLO assessment data were not yet available to evaluate student achievement. The program identified the need to establish baseline assessment data using the newly developed Watermark rubrics to measure student performance and inform future improvement efforts.	Because the program was new, sufficient assessment data were not yet available to identify trends in student achievement of PLO 1 and PLO 3. Faculty determined that consistent assessment of using the new Watermark rubrics was needed to establish baseline performance and identify areas for future improvement.	Embedded assessment of effective office communication using current technologies into ADMN 1311 and BUSN 1302 and implemented the new Watermark rubrics to collect PLO assessment data.	The new Watermark rubrics were successfully implemented in ADMN 1311 and BUSN 1302, establishing a consistent process for assessing student achievement of the identified PLOs. The resulting data provides baseline evidence that faculty can use to identify performance trends and guide future improvement actions.
Entrepreneurship TC	2023-2024	PLO 2- Students will demonstrate a basic understanding of financial statements, budgets, and other documents necessary to plan, track and measure the financial well-being of a business.	Review of the assessment data identified insufficient evidence to fully evaluate student achievement of PLO 2 due to an incomplete rubric and reliance on a single program-level measure. An additional aligned assessment was needed to provide more meaningful evidence of students' financial literacy.	Faculty determined that the existing assessment process did not provide sufficient evidence to evaluate students' ability to interpret and apply financial information in entrepreneurial decision-making. Adding a financial accounting problem from ACCT 1010 would provide an additional direct measure of student learning and strengthen assessment of PLO 2.	Added an accounting problem from ACCT 1010 to the certificate assessment process to measure students' ability to interpret financial reports and apply financial information to entrepreneurial decision-making.	The additional accounting assessment was implemented, providing a second direct measure of PLO 2 and strengthening the program's ability to evaluate students' financial literacy. Results will be reviewed in the next assessment cycle to identify performance trends and determine whether additional improvement actions are needed.
Diagnostic Medical Sonography TC	2023-2024	PLO 3- Record, analyze, and process diagnostic data and other pertinent observations made during the procedure for presentation to the interpreting physician.	Although the most recent assessment results showed 100% achievement, performance varied across assessment years, indicating a need for greater consistency in the assessment of students' clinical skills.	Faculty determined that lab protocols could be better aligned with the skills, efficiency, and performance expectations of entry-level sonographers. Employer feedback further identified the importance of preparing students to complete examinations within appropriate clinical timeframes.	Faculty revised lab protocols to more accurately reflect expectations for new graduate sonographers in the clinical setting, including appropriate time requirements for completing examinations.	Most lab protocols were revised, and time requirements were added to better reflect expectations in the clinical setting. These changes strengthened alignment with employer feedback and provided students with more realistic practice in performing examinations efficiently and preparing for workforce expectations.

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Emergency Medical Services (Basic, Advanced Accelerated) TC	2023-2024	PLO 1- The student will utilize appropriate techniques to perform a patient assessment of an injured person of multi-system trauma and formulate a treatment plan for all conditions and injuries discovered.	Assessment results showed a slight decline in student performance related to trauma assessment competencies, indicating a need to strengthen students' ability to consistently assess trauma patients and make appropriate clinical decisions.	Faculty identified trauma assessment as an area requiring additional emphasis and hands-on practice. A focused simulation activity was determined to be an appropriate strategy for strengthening students' patient assessment, treatment planning, and clinical decision-making skills.	Develop and implement a simulation activity focused on Trauma Assessment.	The Trauma Assessment simulation was implemented with a target average student score of 70% or higher. The National Registry discontinued reporting trauma assessment data following implementation of its new examination, so external comparative data are no longer available. Future effectiveness will be evaluated using internal Trauma Assessment simulation results and trends from the program's self-assessment survey to determine whether student performance improves and whether additional actions are needed.
Paramedic TC	2023-2024	PLO 3- The student will integrate and synthesize the multiple determinants of the general pathophysiology of the human body relative to patient assessment, critical thinking and treatment.	Although student achievement remained consistently high, minor variations across assessment cycles indicated a need to sustain and reinforce students' ability to integrate clinical knowledge and make appropriate treatment decisions.	Faculty determined that students would benefit from additional opportunities to integrate pathophysiology, patient assessment, and treatment decisions in realistic clinical scenarios. Case-based discussions were identified as a strategy to reinforce critical thinking and support consistent clinical decision-making across cohorts.	Integrated a Case Study Discussion Series into the Paramedic Lab course (2402), with participation from the Medical Director, to provide students with structured opportunities to apply clinical knowledge to realistic patient scenarios.	The Case Study Discussion Series was successfully integrated into the Paramedic Lab course (2402) with participation from the Medical Director. Student participation was 100%, as completion is required for Medical Director sign-off, and all participating students reported that the case studies were useful and provided a positive learning experience. Future PLO 3 assessment results will be reviewed to determine whether the case studies support sustained achievement in clinical reasoning and treatment decision-making.
Fire Science AAS/TC	2023-2024	PLO 2- Apply foundational fire science knowledge to "real world" scenarios and describe how the knowledge and skills can be applied to fire science related occupations.	Although student achievement remained high, assessment results showed a slight decline from 2021 to 2022, indicating a need to reinforce students' ability to apply fire science knowledge and skills in real-world settings.	Faculty analysis of assessment results identified an opportunity to strengthen students' application of fire science concepts through additional experiential learning. Expanding external learning experiences was identified as a strategy to connect classroom learning with current fire service practices and workforce expectations.	Increased external learning opportunities within FIRE courses through activities such as site visits, engagement with fire service professionals, and other applied learning experiences.	External learning assignments have been incorporated into 19 of the 21 FIRE courses, with FIRE 2310 and FIRE 2340 remaining to be completed. This represents substantial implementation of the improvement action across the curriculum. Future PLO assessment results will be analyzed to determine whether the expanded experiential learning opportunities support sustained or improved student achievement of PLO 2.

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Medical Lab Technology TC	2023-2024	PLO 6- Demonstrate the necessary knowledge to pass national certification examinations and meet the criteria for licensure established by the Tennessee Medical Laboratory Board.	Student achievement remained very high; however, faculty identified an opportunity to further strengthen students' preparation for the Board of Certification (BOC) examination and support consistently high certification outcomes.	Faculty analysis of PLO 6 and certification results identified an opportunity to provide students with additional structured preparation for the BOC examination. Review materials and practice examinations were selected to reinforce content, identify areas requiring additional preparation, and provide further evidence of student readiness for certification.	Incorporated a certification review book and practice examinations into MLAB 2270, Seminar II, to provide structured preparation and strengthen student readiness for the BOC examination.	The review book and practice examinations were successfully incorporated into MLAB 2270. The program's current three-year average BOC pass rate is 97%, demonstrating strong overall certification performance. Future BOC pass rates and practice examination results will be monitored to determine whether this level of achievement is sustained following implementation of the additional preparation resources.
Professional Music				Closed Program No Longer offered 2023		
Entertainment Media Production AAS	2023-2024	PLO 3- Design and manipulate digital images to create effective communications for the entertainment industry.	Assessment of students' technical proficiency identified a need for continued access to current industry-standard equipment and technology to ensure students develop skills aligned with evolving professional expectations.	Faculty analysis of PLO 3 identified access to current industry-standard equipment and technology as important to strengthening students' technical proficiency. Increased hands-on experience with equipment used in the entertainment media industry was identified as a strategy to strengthen applied learning and workforce preparation.	Secured grant funding to purchase current industry-standard equipment and expand hands-on learning opportunities throughout the program.	Approximately \$200,000 in new industry-standard equipment was purchased through grant funding and is now being used by students in the program, substantially expanding opportunities for hands-on learning with current technology. Future PLO 3 assessment results will be analyzed to determine whether the expanded access supports sustained or improved technical proficiency and workforce readiness
Fine Arts- Art AFA	2023-2024	PLO 5- Students will present works in a variety of expressive platforms.	Assessment results showed lower achievement and inconsistent student performance in presentation-related skills, indicating a need for additional opportunities for students to develop and demonstrate proficiency in presenting their artwork.	Faculty analysis of PLO 5 results identified limited opportunities for students to practice and demonstrate presentation skills beyond the Annual Student Art Show. Faculty determined that repeated opportunities to publicly showcase artwork could strengthen students' confidence, presentation skills, and achievement of PLO 5.	Expanded opportunities for students to publicly showcase and present their artwork through campus and community exhibitions and statewide competitions, with a goal of increasing PLO 5 achievement to at least 73%.	Students now have expanded opportunities to showcase their artwork through exhibitions in the VSCC Gallery, an annual fall exhibition at the Gallatin Public Library, and participation in the TBR Annual Art Award competition. VSCC student artwork has received the TBR award for three consecutive years, providing external recognition of the quality of student work. Future PLO 5 assessment results will be analyzed to determine whether the expanded presentation opportunities support achievement of the 73% target.

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Communications General Education Review (GER)	2023-2024	GE Outcome 1- Compose a variety of original messages using effective written communication skills. GE Outcome 4- Apply appropriate communication skills to move an idea from process to outcome	English assessment results identified challenges with students' understanding and application of rhetorical strategies (PLO 1) and the writing process (PLO 4), including drafting, revision, and feedback. Communication assessment identified a need for a more consistent method of measuring student progress throughout the semester.	English: Faculty determined that rhetorical concepts needed to be more intentionally scaffolded and that students would benefit from explicit instruction throughout each stage of the writing process, including pre-writing, drafting, feedback, revision, and editing. Communication: Faculty determined that assessment could be strengthened through a common benchmark assignment aligned with updated student learning outcomes to consistently measure student progress and identify areas requiring additional support.	English: Developed and implemented an OER model course for ENGL 1020 with increased scaffolding and consistent instruction of key concepts. The course was piloted in Fall 2024 and expanded to most online asynchronous sections, with some face-to-face faculty also using the model. A faculty workgroup also developed a new ENGL 0810 co-requisite model, implemented beginning Fall 2025. Communication: Revised and implemented a common benchmark assignment aligned with updated student learning outcomes. Data collection using the revised assessment began in Spring 2025.	English: The ENGL 1020 OER model course was successfully piloted and expanded, and the ENGL 0810 co-requisite model was implemented beginning Fall 2025. Subsequent PLO assessment results will be analyzed to determine whether these changes improve student achievement in rhetorical strategies and the writing process. Communication: The revised benchmark assignment was implemented, and initial assessment data collection began in Spring 2025. Additional semesters of student learning outcome data will be collected and analyzed to determine changes in student achievement and identify areas requiring further improvement.
Veterinary Technology AAS	2023-2024	PLO 1- Demonstrate knowledge of hospital procedures, communicate in all formats and recognize applicable laws	Hospital Procedures: Assessment results showed a downward trend, with achievement falling below the program's established 95% target. The related VET 215 CLO 4 assessment also identified medical record skills as an area requiring further investigation and reinforcement.	Faculty analysis of PLO 1 and CLO 215.4 identified a need to reinforce medical record skills between their introduction in the spring and assessment in the fall. Faculty also noted that PLO 1 includes professionalism and that missing or arriving late to labs contributed to some students not meeting expectations	Developed and implemented an animal care quiz incorporating medical record questions to reinforce skills between initial instruction and subsequent assessment. The goal was to increase achievement of VET 215 CLO 4 and PLO 1 to greater than 95%.	Following implementation, PLO 1 achievement increased from 95.17% in 2023-2024 to 97.22% in 2024-2025, exceeding the program's goal of greater than 95%. Achievement of VET 215 CLO 4 remained at 100% in both 2024 and 2025. These results demonstrate improved PLO 1 achievement and sustained high performance on the related medical records CLO following implementation of the additional learning activity.

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Mathematics General Education Review (GER)	2023-2024	GE Outcome 1- Build on (not replicate) the competencies gained through the study of two years of high school algebra and one year of high school geometry. GE Outcome 2- Use mathematics to solve problems and determine if the solutions are reasonable. GE Outcome 6- Apply mathematical and/or basic statistical reasoning to analyze data and graphs.	Assessment results showed declining achievement across several mathematics General Education outcomes, with notable concerns in gateway mathematics courses. MATH 1130 showed declines across multiple outcomes, and selected CLOs, including Quadratic Equations in MATH 1130 and Hypothesis Testing in MATH 1530, identified areas requiring additional attention.	Faculty analysis of PLO, CLO, and disaggregated gateway-course data identified declines in multiple mathematics outcomes during and following the COVID-19 period. MATH 1130 demonstrated particularly significant declines, while analysis of selected CLOs identified specific mathematical concepts requiring reinforcement. Faculty also identified a need to review assessment mappings and questions to ensure they appropriately measure the intended PLOs and CLOs.	Revised Learning Support courses, piloted multiple learning platforms, made changes to calculator-use policies, and developed additional instructional and Learning Support materials for gateway mathematics courses. The additional materials were provided to students beginning in Spring 2025.	Initial AY 2024-2025 assessment results provide follow-up evidence as the revised instructional and Learning Support strategies were being implemented. In MATH 1130, achievement was strongest in Linear Equations (90.96%) and Graphs (89.83%), while Quadratic Equations (69.49%), Inequalities (64.97%), Exponential Equations (62.15%), and Logarithmic Equations (56.50%) remain areas for continued improvement. In MATH 1530, achievement was strongest in Organizing Data (83.84%) and Calculating Measures (81.90%), while Hypothesis Testing (56.92%) and Linear Regression (65.20%) remain areas requiring additional attention. Faculty will continue to analyze PLO and CLO results in subsequent assessment cycles to determine the effectiveness of the instructional and Learning Support changes and identify additional improvement actions
History General Education Review (GER)	2023-2024	GE Outcome 1- Analyze historical facts and interpretations. GE Outcome 2- Analyze and compare political, geographic, economic, social, cultural, religious and intellectual institutions, structures, and processes across a range of historical periods and cultures. GE Outcome 3- Recognize and articulate the diversity of human experience across a range of historical periods and the complexities of a global culture and society.	Overall assessment results showed generally strong student achievement; however, disaggregated results identified achievement gaps among some student populations, including first-generation students and students of color. The findings indicated a need for additional academic support to strengthen students' ability to analyze historical evidence, compare perspectives, and apply historical thinking skills.	Faculty analysis of the disaggregated assessment results identified a need for additional academic support to address achievement gaps. Discipline-specific tutoring was selected as a strategy to provide students with targeted assistance in developing historical analysis and critical-thinking skills, with the Learning Commons identified as the location for expanded faculty tutoring.	Expanded History tutoring through the Learning Commons. At its highest level of implementation in Spring 2025, two to four full-time History faculty maintained regular weekly tutoring hours. When utilization remained low, the department revised the approach so students seeking History assistance through the Learning Commons could be referred directly to faculty during designated office hours.	The tutoring initiative was implemented, but student participation remained very low and no measurable or trackable improvement in student learning was identified. Based on the limited utilization, faculty shifted from scheduled Learning Commons tutoring to an on-call referral model using faculty office hours. Future GELO assessment results will be reviewed to determine whether additional or different strategies are needed to address identified achievement gaps.

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Criminal Justice AAS/TC	2023-2024	PLO 1- Students will demonstrate the knowledge and skills necessary for an entry level position in the criminal justice field.	Assessment results identify inconsistent achievement across Criminal Justice learning outcomes. Approximately 60% of students met expectations in Terms and Concepts, Evidence and Investigation, and Organizational Structure, compared with approximately 88% in Individual Rights and Safety Procedures and Protocols. Exit exam results also showed inconsistent achievement and that the program did not consistently meet its established benchmark.	Faculty analysis of PLO, CLO, and exit exam results identified areas requiring additional reinforcement, particularly foundational terms and concepts, evidence and investigation, and organizational structure. Exit exam averages ranged from 61% to 87% across assessment periods, indicating a need for additional preparation to help students retain and apply knowledge from across the comprehensive two-year curriculum. Faculty also identified a need to strengthen curriculum mapping and assessment processes to ensure PLOs are appropriately aligned, assessed, and monitored.	. Developed a comprehensive Criminal Justice Exit Exam study guide to reinforce knowledge and concepts learned throughout the program. After identifying limited initial distribution, faculty expanded access in August 2025 by making the study guide available through the Testing Center webpage, Graduation Exit Exams webpage, and the online scheduling system used to register for the Criminal Justice Exit Exam. Faculty and interim leadership also began strengthening curriculum mapping and assessment processes to improve alignment between CLOs and PLOs.	Access to the Criminal Justice Exit Exam study guide was substantially expanded, addressing the initial concern that students had limited awareness of and access to the resource. The study guide is now available through multiple Testing Center resources, including the exam registration process. Curriculum mapping and assessment processes are also being strengthened to support more consistent measurement of student learning. Subsequent exit exam and PLO results will be analyzed to determine whether increased access to study materials and strengthened assessment practices support improved and more consistent student achievement.
University Parallel AA/AS	2023-2024	PLO 3- Students will understand and apply knowledge of the foundations and practice in relevant mathematical skills	Assessment results showed that student achievement in quantitative reasoning remained below the established goal. AY 2023-2024 achievement was 57.88%, indicating a continued need to strengthen foundational quantitative skills and provide additional support in Gateway mathematics courses.	Analysis of PLO 3 results showed a 5.38 percentage-point increase from 2022; however, achievement remained below the established goal. Faculty identified foundational quantitative skills as an area requiring continued reinforcement and determined that strengthening instructional materials and Learning Support in Gateway mathematics courses could better prepare students to develop and apply quantitative reasoning skills throughout the AA/AS curriculum.	Developed and incorporated additional course and Learning Support materials into Gateway mathematics courses to reinforce foundational quantitative skills and improve student achievement of PLO 3.	The Gateway course and Learning Support materials were developed and incorporated to provide additional support for quantitative reasoning. Because the AY 2023-2024 PLO 3 result of 57.88% preceded or informed the improvement action, subsequent PLO 3 assessment results will be analyzed to determine the effectiveness of the additional materials and whether student achievement demonstrates continued progress toward the established goal.